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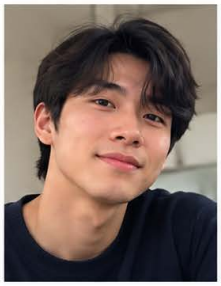
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A Table of Contents is mandatory and must be included in the assignment.

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1.0 Introduction

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The philosophy of technology emerged after the second industrial revolution in the 19th century. It exists to examine the nature, impact, and ethical implications of technology either good or bad in a society. This research paper will be focused on how social media today gradually shapes people's lifestyles and influences the mindset of future generations. Before the topic goes further, it's essential to have an understanding to social media platforms.

Social media platform is the digital space used for users to connect, share content and interact with people globally. For example, platforms like Instagram, Facebook, TikTok and Twitter allow users to share visual content, even messages for personal expression and community engagement (Dixon, 2022). By helping to create the culture and communication, these platforms would promote the trends, raise virtual communities and spread the information rapidly (Kaplan & Haenlein,2010). Although social media platforms offer such benefits, it also possesses a dark side which should be looked for.

In-text citations are mandatory and must be included throughout the assignment.

First and foremost, social media plays a massive part in the language aspect. English has dominated social media most, especially among globally influential and creator communities. Despite English being an international language, this dominance has led to the trends that prioritize English over other languages among teenagers, particularly in non-English countries. Over time, this shift can create a sense of shame about using one's mother tongue, especially if it is not seen as 'cool' or 'modern' in the digital world. Society may lose native languages with cultural richness and identity while the teenager is exposed to the language of global influencers and cyber culture. This transformation raises critical questions about the erosion of cultural languages and the potential long-term consequences for teenagers' sense of self and their connection to their cultural heritage (Gundara, 2014).

Besides, social media has transformed the way adolescents interact with each other, particularly in the development of social skills. Face to face (F2F) communication traditionally served as the basis for learning the fundamental social skills of interpreting non-verbal cues, managing emotions and resolving conflicts. Through body language, facial expressions, and tone of voice, individuals can be understood to be engaging in real time F2F conversations. However, teenagers are increasingly exposed to the edited and curated interaction, while the digital interaction replaces the F2F communication. The shift in communication styles has not

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Use 1.5 line spacing throughout the assignment.

only hindered teenagers' ability to read and understand social cues, but it has also prevented teenagers from taking part in real time conflict resolution, critical thinking and improvisational problem solving (Wang, 2024).

In addition, one of the major problems among social media is the impact of the idealised pictures of life and beauty. On platforms like Instagram and TikTok, users always share their best moments in carefully edited photos and videos that are a polished version of their lives. This has created an unrealistic standard of beauty, success and happiness among teenagers which omits the struggles in reality. Since teens see flawless skin, perfect bodies, even perfect lifestyles as they scroll through their feeds, which may lead to negative comparisons and feelings of inadequacy. Therefore, mental health problems like anxiety, depression and low self-esteem are caused by this phenomenon because they will feel under the stress to match up these unrealisable expectations (Vogels et al., 2022).

Moreover, the digital age has changed the way teenagers consume in many ways, and social media influencers have come to be the heroes in this story. Influencers have become young audiences' trusted sources of information, trendsetters, and have been sharing their lifestyles, recommending products and pronouncing personal experiences. Hence, they can create parasocial relationships and show aspirational lifestyles, which have significantly influenced teenagers' purchasing decisions, directly making them important players in the ever-changing consumer market.

In this case, social media impact on teenagers' cultural language, social skills, and mental health is crucial to be explored. This essay will demonstrate through studying the reasons in what ways social media can be beneficial and harmful to teenagers as they endeavour to live in a more modern digital world. Furthermore, this essay also offers recommendations on how to maintain the positive aspects of social media while ensuring the importance of meaningful, real-life interactions for healthy development and wellbeing.

2.0 Research Questions

i. How do various elements of social media shape unrealistic beauty ideals, and in what ways does the difference between carefully curated and unfiltered content influence these ideals?

ii. What impact do idealized images of life on social networks have on people's perceptions of their bodies, mental health and self-esteem, especially when compared to their unadorned reality?

iii. How does social media influence cultural language among teenagers?

iv. How do social media interactions compare to face-to-face interactions in shaping the development of social skills in youth?

v. How do social media influencers impact consumer behaviour and lifestyle choices among teenagers?

3.0 Objectives of Discussion

i. To explore how the elements of social media shape unrealistic beauty ideals and compare the impact of curated content with unfiltered content.

ii. To examine the impact that idealized images of life on social networks have on people's perceptions of their bodies, mental health and self-esteem when compared to their unadorned reality.

iii. To study how social media influences cultural language among teenagers.

iv. To discover how social media interactions compare to face-to-face interactions in shaping the development of social skills in youth.

v. To investigate how social media influencers impact consumer behaviour and lifestyle choices among teenagers.

4.0 Importance of Study

This study is important in understanding how social media affects lifestyles and the perspectives of future generations. Social media has transformed the way that people connect, express, and perceive the world. However, the curated nature that formed by social media often obscures reality. Therefore, it has led to significant psychological consequences, especially on adolescents and young children. Research by Smith and Ander (2022) indicates that popular social media platforms used by most Americans like Instagram and Snapchat, which promote an idealized lifestyle that leads to negative self-comparison. Meanwhile, Khalaf (2023) found that teenages who spend excessive on social media more likely experience anxiety, depression and feelings of inadequacy. According to Twenge, Martin and Spitzberg (2019) also realized that increased digital media usage across the past several decades was associated with declines in adolescent mental health.

In addition to mental health, social media also plays an important role in defining how our society behaves and norms as a whole. There is a study from Wallace 2020, they emphasized on platforms normalising unattainable ideals that "filter culture" has created unrealistic beauty standards, contributing to increased interest in cosmetic procedures. Furthermore, according to a Statista report in 2023, 74% of the users stated to be depending on social media to guide their purchasing decisions, which is proven to be true economically. These trends are troubling in terms of ethical marketing and over consumerism. Given that 95% of teens live with smartphones and use social media daily, its influence on shaping identity, aspirations and values is undeniable (Smith & Anderson, 2018).

It is essential to understand these dynamics for fostering a more media literature culture. Therefore, it will help users think critically and use the digital world wisely. Such programs promoted by UNESCO (2023) are aiming to improve digital literacy as well as helping people to differentiate the curated with authentic narratives. Moreover, it’s also provided insights with the policy and regulations regarding topics related to cyberbullying, misinformation, even data privacy. For example, UNESCO’s media education tools emphasize on the role of ethical standards and accountability in the digital world.

Last but not least, it is necessary to understand the role of social media influencers in shaping teenage consumption behavior so as to discover how external influencer can affect teenagers when they decide. The central finding of this study is that parasocial interaction and aspirational lifestyles foster teenagers to adopt influencers and trends. Influencers create brand awareness of such varied brands and values as sustainability and cultural appreciation, as they help produce more inclusive and conscious about social society generation of consumers. So, these findings serve as important observations for marketers, parents, and educators to guide them through influencer effects, both negative and positive, on teenage consumption behavior.

In summary, studying the hidden truth of social media is vital for evaluating its dual nature, which contributes as the connection and inspirations or result to insecurities and harmful behaviors. Through informed research and proactive measures, society may minimise the negative impact of social media to ensure that future generations are able to respond to it wisely.

5.0 What is an Unrealistic Beauty Idea?

Unrealistic beauty ideals are the concept of having expectations of how people should look. They more often set a level of perfection that's almost impossible to reach, such as flawless skin, a particular form, or perfectly symmetrical qualities. These ideals can put pressure on people to feel self-abased about what other people are supposed to be and struggle with self-worth or even make poor choices.

5.1 Various Elements of Social Media Shape Unrealistic Beauty Ideals

5.1.1 Advertisement

One of the biggest fuel generators of unrealistic beauty standards on social media platforms are advertisements. Brands and companies spend billions of dollars each year on marketing that designs using airbrushed models and hyper-idealized images to present their products in the most putting-forward way possible.

Also, some brands will use heavily edited images to create a culture where perfection seems normal. For instance, in November 2014, Victoria's Secret launched its "Perfect Body"

campaign, featuring ten models who looked strikingly similar in body shape and size. The campaign sparked criticism for promoting a narrow view of beauty and lacking body diversity. Many were also frustrated with how the company misled consumers about the models' appearances, which were digitally altered (Bahadur, 2017). The advertisements continue to perpetuate a culture of perfection that does not account for diversity in what a human body looks like, what a skin tone should be, or what their personal experience is. Even though people are aware that such images are edited, the constant exposure still makes these ideals seem desirable. Beyond this, it causes dissatisfaction with one's own body and encourages actions like extreme dieting, compulsive exercising, and even cosmetic surgeries in hopes of achieving these unrealistic standards.

To truly deal with these harmful standards, a collective effort is essential. The Dove Campaign for Real Beauty is an example of how advertising can promote more inclusive beauty ideals. This global campaign showcases unedited images of women with diverse body types and skin tones, encouraging people to embrace their natural beauty and celebrate authenticity (Weissbrot et al., n.d.). Studies support the positive impact of these initiatives—Hutt (2024) reported that the campaign helped participants develop a greater appreciation for diverse beauty and improved their self-esteem, reducing anxiety about their appearance.

5.1.2 Editing photo application

With the popularity of photo editing apps, like Photoshop, Facetune, and Instagram and Snapchat filters, anyone with a smartphone can change how they look. What once only applied to professional photos is now required usage on our everyday social media pages, where manipulated images have become more the norm than the exception. A photo is easy to enhance—smoothing skin, reshaping features, or adding a "healthy glow" to a photo—it makes us exist in a world where 'perfect' is attainable and "real" seems inadequate.

A survey by the Feragen (2014) found that 50% of social media users edit their photos before sharing them on platforms like Facebook, Instagram, and Twitter. This is because almost every platform has built-in editing tools these days, making the line blur between reality and fantasy more and more with every click of the mouse (Henriques & Patnaik, 2020). People who see such idealized photos by influencers and celebrities tend to treat the photos like things that should be followed. Their compulsion to modify their photos to meet the beauty standards showcased in the pictures of the influencers and celebrities. According to a University of London study, 90% of young women reported using filters or editing before posting photos to

alter their appearance (Wyk, 2021). The problem with this is that the images people see online are routinely manipulated, and normalized digitally; rarely are they accurate depictions of reality, but rather highly curated and over-produced depictions in an attempt to meet unattainable ideals.

This, in turn, breeds a collective mentality that natural beauty is not enough, and that to be the so-called 'perfect' version of oneself, can only be achieved by altering oneself digitally. Not only does it change people's thoughts on how they portray themselves online, but it also manipulates their natural selves offline. This places pressure on us to become digital conformists, refusing to accept our natural imperfections and further mental health issues including anxiety and depression.

5.1.3 Celebrity influence

Social media plays a central role in advancing and keeping the ideal of unrealistic and unrealistic beauty via celebrities. Having a large number of supporters, they are role models for many people; young people often aspire to celebrities for inspiration on how they look, how they should be living, and include personal values. The world of celebrities is highly curated and extremely controlled, which means they present themselves in a wonderful way like perfect bodies, flawless skin, and enviable lives. What people easily forget is that it is a blend of professional styling, makeup, lighting, personal trainers, and maybe even cosmetic surgeries. - The Kardashians are a prominent example of this—they've built an empire on promoting highly curated and altered versions of themselves, convincing young women that their appearances are simply the result of workouts and healthy diets. In reality, their looks are enhanced by surgeries, cosmetic procedures, and photo editing (Hafeez & Zulfiqar, 2023). Also, Essena O'Neill, an Australian influencer, admitted that her popular Instagram photos were heavily edited to make her look more attractive, and she eventually quit social media, revealing the pressures behind influencer culture (BBC, 2015).

And the result is a twisted sense of beauty and self-worth. Young women, more than almost anyone else, are made to feel that they have to look like their favourite celebrity to be considered attractive or valuable. A study involving 227 female university students showed that many women compare their appearance to that of celebrities not to family members, often negatively when browsing Facebook (Fardouly & Vartanian, 2015). If we do not control these feelings, we will lead to harmful behaviors, like wanting cosmetic surgery, taking unhealthy diet pills, and being on superstitious fitness routines. Thus, celebrities' influence is

spread beyond admiration, it changes the way people see themselves, and causes unhealthy comparisons that result in being destructive not only to mental but also to physical well-being.

5.2 Curated 'Fake' Lifestyles vs. Hidden Realities

Social media is a space for people to share only the best parts: the best parts of our lives, the best angles, and the most exciting adventures. As users scroll through, users are bombarded with images of slim, toned bodies, glowing skin, and seemingly perfect lives. These visuals are often edited to erase imperfections and enhance features, creating a distorted view of reality. Oftentimes the struggles, the imperfections, the challenges that everybody will face, are what is left out. This is created by influencers, celebrities, and even regular users who create their online presence to showcase only the highlights of their lives. then people share only the best part of their lives online, the gap between the perfect image they choose to share online compared to what they don't is amplified.

This makes for a huge impact on the audience of curation because we cannot escape from using social media. Platforms like Instagram play a crucial role in shaping beauty standards. It is because over 95 million photos are shared on Instagram daily, and Instagram has become a main contributor to public beauty standards (Franchina & Coco, 2018). This shows that unhealthy comparisons and dissatisfaction manifest themselves in a never-ending stream of seemingly perfect lives. We start to think about our true worth compared to the highlights curated by others online which are frequently not the whole image.

6.0 Impact that Idealized Images of Life on Social Networks Have on People's Perceptions When Compared to Their Unadorned Reality

The advent of social networks has significantly changed people's view of their bodies, encouraging a standardized standard of beauty and attractiveness that focuses on limited and often unattainable norms (Merino et al., 2024).

Idealized images of people on social networks have a deep psychological effect, affecting how people look at their bodies, mental health and self-esteem. Constant exposure to carefully selected content can cause the comparison itself, which can cause anxiety and a sense of inadequacy. These photos often distort reality, which makes people feel alienated from who

they really are and fuels dissatisfaction with the body. The assimilation of these ideals can negatively affect mental health, reduce self-esteem and develop unrealistic expectations for life and beauty.

6.1 Impact on Mental Health

Idealized images on social media have a significant negative impact on mental health and can lead to conditions such as depression and body dysmorphic disorder (Bü low, 2023)

6.1.1 Depression

Constant self-comparison can lead to depression, which is characterized by unhappiness, hopelessness and disinterest in daily activities.

According to The Clinical Committee (2019), more depression was significantly correlated with an increase in social media participation. The study showed that 29% of people who used social networks at least 58 times a week had high symptoms of depression, while only 19% of people who used them 8 or less times a week had such symptoms. Vise versa, 36% of those who attended fewer sessions reported having mild depressive symptoms, while only 16% of those who attended 58 or more sessions per week.

6.1.2 Body Dysmorphic Disorder (BDD)

Since social networking sites such as Instagram often include idealized, carefully selected photos that support unattainable beauty standards, social networks have made a significant contribution to the aggravation of BDD. Especially for teenagers and young people who still form a sense of their own movement, these exquisite and filtered photos can lead to serious self-comparisons. People who regularly encounter such photos may learn these standards and become more dissatisfied with how they look.

Consequently, people with BDD can look for cosmetic surgery to "correct" what they consider defects. Cosmetic procedures, however, are unlikely to ever reduce the psychological suffering caused by the disease.

6.2 Impact on Self-Esteem

According to Dr. Richelle Mayshak from the School of Psychology at Deakin University (Mayshak, 2018), social networking sites such as Facebook and Instagram have the potential to spread idealized images, which can lead to low self-esteem. Ahe mentioned that social comparisons and feelings of unpopularity, for example, when messages do not receive the expected number of likes, are often the causes of these bad emotions. This shows how social networks can have a psychological impact on people, especially when it comes to encouraging inability and unreasonable expectations. Furthermore, 20% of adults and most adolescents suffer from dissatisfaction with their body because of social networks, as they often contrast their own lives with carefully groomed, idealized images of others. Adolescents are particularly at risk, as the constant exposure to these idealized images often has a detrimental effect on their developing sense of self and body image (Krzymowski, 2024).

In addition, this dynamic contributes to a feeling of inferiority and jealousy, as individuals compare themselves to the content online. Social media like Instagram compound this problem by displaying aesthetically pleasing but unattainable content that feeds users' self-doubt and perfectionist tendencies. Widespread discontent and a sense of separation from the true self are the results.

6.3 Unrealistic Expectations for Life and Beauty

The distorted view of reality is caused by unrealistic expectations of life and beauty, which are influenced by representation of romanticized ideas on social networks. Social media networks usually show carefully selected examples of success, achievement and lifestyle perfection, setting impossible standards. These images are often devoid of context and mention the shortcomings and difficulties that arise with the human being.

This emphasis on perfection contributes to the idea that success and beauty have limited definitions, which encourages people to strive for these impractical ideals. In addition to distorting reality, the emphasis on material achievements and digitally improved aesthetics promotes a culture of comparison. As a result, people are under pressure to fit in because of these dynamics, which fuels a vicious circle of discontent and pursuit of impossible goals (Cleveland Clinic, 2023).

6.4 Real Examples in Gender-Specific Beauty Pressures

While social media platforms have tacitly amplified unrealistic beauty standards, the nature and impact of these pressures vary across genders. We start to think about our true worth compared to the highlights curated by others online which are frequently not the whole image. This has such a psychological impact, that people get to believe their own lives are not complete because they are not like the perfection they see on social media. Adolescence is a vulnerable period for body dissatisfaction in social media—half of boys and 74% of girls at age 14 wish they could change something about their bodies, leading to issues like poor self-esteem and eating disorders (Vuong et al., 2021). This shows that people will experience anxiety, depression, and feelings of alienation because people think they are not enough compared to others.

For girls, the ideals are almost universally about being feminine, and that usually relates to looking perfect – flawless skin, youthful features, and a slim body. Girls are often told to make themselves look prettier through makeup, cosmetic procedures, and clothing options that supplement their 'ideal' body. In recent years, around the time filters and other augmented reality (AR) tools that alter facial and body features became widely popular, offering users an easy way to 'perfect' their looks. While these tools are marketed as empowering enhancements, they can often create new and unattainable standards of beauty. This is because filters even will make the most natural, untouched features look inadequate, creating almost impossible dissonance between real and ideal beauty. This false representation creates a large sense of insecurity around people who are comparing themselves to these edited, perfectly flawless pictures that they see.

Social media puts equal pressure, and in different ways, on boys. Social media influencers of the fitness industry are perpetuating an unrealistic idea of what masculinity is all about which it should be extreme muscularity and low body fat. Hypermasculine physiques are often pushed by the successful influencers in the fitness world, many of whom espouse unattainable body types, necessary to achieve through extreme exercise regimens and unrealistic dieting. It is these ideals that have convinced so many young men that their worth is linked straight to their physical appearance. Achieving the ‘perfect’ body comes with unrealistic and pressure-filled due to this, it is not only harmful but also often dangerous. Griffiths et al. (2019) found in a 2019 study hyper exposure to ideal male physiques on social media led to 60% of young men reporting body dissatisfaction. This expectation is additionally

a factor in increased charges of body discontent and sick practices among men, from the utilization of steroids and enhancements to the utilization of extreme wellness regimens that can prompt poor well-being.

Additionally, social media sites frequently push trends like 'six-pack abs,' 'Greek god physique,' and so on things that many men will never be able to achieve from a genetic standpoint or due to their lifestyle circumstances. There is a danger that can lead to feelings of inadequacy, frustration, and low self-esteem, and ultimately to the use of high-risk behavior including over-training or the misuse of performance-enhancing substances. According to Nadine Palmer (2024), there exists pressure on young men to meet these ideals, leaving many to believe that they are worthy tied to their physical appearance, leading to feeling negative about themselves and potentially practicing dangerous acts.

This becomes a bigger issue when social media is flooded with 'perfect' bodies - both male and female - without showing how real life is. Rather, most of the time, behind the polished images are realities about excessive time spent on grooming, makeup, styling hair, and editing the photos to fit the ideal. The difference between online curated, 'fake' lifestyles and real lives or more imperfect realities that people experience creates feelings of isolation and disappointment. This kind of unrealistic beauty tendency to demand them to live up to often unrealized ideals contributes to the difficulty of individuals accepting their natural bodies and leads to a bad cycle of self-criticism and low self-esteem.

In brief, people's views on their body, mental health and self-esteem are strongly influenced by idealized images on social media platforms. The rise of depression and reduced self-esteem are the result of frequent promotion of these platforms of unrealistic ideals of success and attractiveness. This type of exposure increases anxiety, aggravates dissatisfaction with the body and can lead to serious diseases, including dysmorphic body disorder and depression. Because of their increased impressionability and susceptibility to the requirements of curatorial perfection, teenagers and young people especially suffer. Promoting digital literacy, encouraging diverse and realistic images and developing positive relationships with social networks are essential to counter these consequences.

7.0 How Does Social Media Influence Cultural Language Among Teenagers?

With the development of technology, teenagers nowadays are different from the past. The cheapest smartphones in Malaysia are priced are only cost for RM 499, making them more affordable for parents to buy for their teens (Top 20 Best Budget Phones In Malaysia, 2024). According to study from Vogels et al. (2022), 95% of teenagers in the United States own their smartphones in 2022, compared to 73% in 2014-2015. The increasing use of smartphones among teenagers allows them to connect with social media and gain a sense of the world, as the internet connects everyone. Through contact with the world, teenagers might be influenced by their own culture, including their language acquisition.

7.1 Impact of Cultural Language on Teenagers

The problem of Eurocentrism is still happening in this world. This ideology refers to the supremacy of Western culture, including values, beliefs, and even languages. It results in a biased interpretation of non-European history and culture, framing them solely from a Western perspective and often deeming Western civilization as inherently superior. For example, this ideology suggests the idea that everyone must learn English and make it the Lingua Franca, leading to the sacrifice of mother tongues. Although nowadays most people no longer follow this ideology, it still lingers. For instance, the education system, such as universities, reflects this. Also, when people travel, English is often the default center of communication (Yadav, 2023). With this phenomenon, it causes problems like ‘mother tongue shame.’

7.1.1 Mother tongue shame

Mother tongue shame among teenagers is common because most of them think their mother tongue is “lame.” Due to the development of adolescence, teenagers are sensitive and require attention from their peers (Bergman, 2023). Teenagers want to be unique, but they also want to fit in with the group. For example, a blogger, Yaldaz Sadakova, shared that in school, he only told his friends about his favorite aspects of his own culture, but he did not want to attract too much attention from others because he was one of the few people of his ethnicity in the school (Sadakova, 2024).

7.1.2 Social media are increasing teenagers' shame about their mother tongue

The rise of social media makes it easier for teenagers to share information. Platforms like Instagram and TikTok are mostly in English, and this could affect their mindset, making them think in a Eurocentric way. This is because a lot of the content is in English, and their immature mindset, along with the desire to be unique and fit in with a group, makes them believe in it. The influencers are using certain language, mostly English, to build connections with teenagers by using slang, puns, and trends to change their behavior, which may affect language use (Prudencio et al., 2023). For example, a teenager's peers are constantly using slang from social media influencers. Everybody is doing the same, and in order to fit into the group, it makes the teenagers imitate and stay focused on trends on social media. This idea reinforces the concept of Eurocentrism for teenagers, making them think English is superior to their own language.

7.2 Social Media Changes Teenagers' Language Acquisition"

The Eurocentrism on social media increases teenagers' language acquisition. The more teenagers use English as the main language on social media platforms, the more they are influenced, such as changing their behavior. For instance, teenagers who tend to speak English are more likely to use apps like Discord or Telegram. This is because the community encourages them to do so, as Europeans use these tools rather than Weibo or WeChat, which are for non-English primary languages. Teenagers impacted by this tend to speak English when they are in public or with friends. Thus, it might cause them to lose connection with their mother tongue, along with their cultural and local identity.

7.3 Intervention of Teenager's Multilingualism

With the rapid spread of information, many more people have realized what is happening among teenagers. By leveraging teenagers' natural tendency to use social media, more and more trends, hashtags, or viral videos are appearing on their For You page as they fear missing out on the video (Bergman, 2023). Here's an example: Ping Zhi (@imcpz), the Malaysian TikTok influencer, uses humour to transmit cultural language to the audience (Zhi, 2021). By mispronouncing words and using hashtags like #malaysiatiktok, #mispronouncingwords, and #malaysian, he makes the TikTok algorithm recommend the video

to the local audience and build a strong connection. This resonates with teenagers who struggle with mother tongue shame and English usage. These kinds of trends help reinforce the idea that their mother language is not shameful. Since teenagers often idolize influencers, local influencers who play with accents and mispronunciations are more likely to help reduce the shame associated with using their mother tongue.

7.3.1 Cultural confidence

The example given above provides a sense for teens that their mother language is nothing to be ashamed of. The change in cultural language among teenagers is also caused by cultural confidence. Cultural confidence refers to people who are proud and confident in their own culture, including beliefs, art, literature, ideas, and language (White, 1999b). With cultural confidence, teens are unlikely to be influenced by social media. It allows teenagers to have an open mind toward multilingualism, leading them to feel confident in their own mother tongue, and it also helps them develop self-confidence (Vermander, 2023).

7.4 Multilingual Education in Schools

Other than fostering cultural confidence, schools play an important role in guiding teens toward inspiration. Nowadays, many schools have realized the importance of multilingual education for students. They offer bilingual programs. The school programs focus on two languages: English and the mother tongue. For example, secondary schools in Malaysia offer many languages for students, such as English, Bahasa Melayu, Tamil, and Chinese. It allows students to keep learning English and Malay, but also their mother tongues, Tamil and Chinese (Jeevita, 2024). Although it might give some stress to the students, it is a way to maintain the students' cultural roots. With the intervention of schools, it is more likely to reinforce the idea of globalization rather than the idea of Eurocentrism, making teens less likely to be influenced by social media content.

8.0 Shaping Social Skills in Youth: Social Media Interactions vs. Face-to-Face Interactions

Social skills are essential for communication as they help in build relationship, solve problems and express emotions (Castelán, 2023). Due to the advancements in technology, people have gradually shifted the primary mode of conversation from face-to-face interactions into social media interactions. This transformation significantly affects how youth develop social skills because of the substantial differences between these forms of interaction.

8.1 Face-to-Face (F2F) Interactions

In real life, F2F conversation occur when two or more people meet each other physically. These conversations often leading individuals to greatly know how is the emotion of the other party through the pick-up of non-verbal cues, which are human facial expression, body gesture, tone of voice and eye contact. F2F conversation prevent misunderstandings, allowing people to clarify messages in real time without delayed as what social media may require when the other party is not online. (Maggie Wooll, 2024)

Besides, F2F conversation require people to think quickly in giving real-time responses. For instance, when resolving conflicts with teammate regarding the different opinion in group work, individuals need to brainstorm and provide credible reason as soon as possible to support the point and prevent the discussion drive into worse situation. Therefore, usually interact through F2F enable youth to adapt with the sudden situations that may occur, as gradually practise help youth to become a better version of self that can cope with emergency situations or problems.

However, study from Lenhart (2015) found out that 72% of teenagers prefer to interact with friends through social media rather than F2F communication. The implement of social media make youth gradually transform their communication preference into an indirect social media communication.

8.2 Why Do Teenagers Choose Social Media Over Face-to-Face Communication?

8.2.1 Strengthens long-distance relationships

Social media allows individuals to interact with friends at any time, from any places, as long as they have mobile devices and internet access. This accessibility enables

individuals to maintain the relationship with friends that not in a same location through posted information of their interest or shared opinions with friends. Regarding the survey from Anderson & Jiang (2018), 81% of youth reported that social media stay them connected with friends, enabling teens to share the same topic and understanding although they have long time did not meet each other.

8.2.2 Enable selectively self-present

According to Walther's Hyperpersonal Model, computer-mediated communication (CMC), including social media, allow individuals build relationships that are highly personal and closer than face-to-face (F2F) interactions. Through social media, youth can selectively present themselves in a way that aligns with how they wish to be shown in public, it means users can set their own characteristic while communicating with others. Unlike F2F communication, social media interactions do not specifically require revealing all personal details or physical appearance. Hence, people can control which preferred cues they choose to send and thereby impress others. (Relationships: Virtual relationships, 2018)

It is good when social media have low presence of non-verbal cues, as youths can control what preferable cues, they are likely to share. This control will make the relationship closer, as the limited cues projected by the communication partner lead the receiver to "fill in the gaps" about what they don't know about the partner, and often idealizing and assuming positive personalities of sender.

8.2.3 Provide more time for message crafting

Compare to face-to-face interactions, which demand immediate response, social media enables individuals to "revise, edit and perfect" their messages before sending them, allowing users to send the message that are more polished and may better fulfil the expectations of the other party. Therefore, it avoids embarrassing errors that may make them regrets.

8.3 Effects of Real-Life Social Skills on Teenagers who Over-Reliance on Social Media

8.3.1 Less confidence

The habit of curating content and crafting response leaves teenagers to feel less confident and unprepared when in real-life conversations. According to Ehmke (2024), teens who heavily rely on social media often feel anxious during F2F direct

communication because they are over-reliance on the communication that not in real-life. Hence, they unable to express themselves naturally when people talk to them. The lack of real-life experiences made them fear to cope with the situation, as there is no space for "revise or edit" their spoken words.

Also, social media limits the chances for teenagers to learn quick thinking, leading to a situation that many can express their opinion very fluent on social media but turn into real-life, he or she becomes frozen and cannot convey their feeling naturally just like what they did online. The social media often provide space for individual to promote their idealize self, which make a big difference when turn into real-life conversation, where there no place to hide imperfections. When time goes by, teenagers might withdraw to have real-life conversations.

8.3.2 Reduce Empathy

Empathy is an emotive ability to understand and share other's feelings, it will gradually shape when one's grown up (Borba, 2016). Non-verbal cues such as facial expression and tone of voice are crucial elements for teens to empathize other's feeling. Whereas, social media, platforms with lower presence of non-verbal cues, make teens face challenges in reading people emotions in physical situation.

Moreover, the "perfect" portrayals often seen on social media encourage youth to see people in a simple way by neglecting the complexity of the real emotion and struggles. This lack of practices in understand real emotion leading them to face difficulties in understanding and resonating with others feeling in F2F settings. Over time, it increases the risk of self-isolation and reduce teens' ability to empathize. (Troomi, 2023)

8.3.3 Long-Term Implications for Future Generations: Workplace Communication

When teens who heavily reliance on social media interactions grow up , it can lead to both benefit and disadvantage situation in the work setting.

Base on the statistics provided by Krook (2024), 92% of today's jobs require digital social skills. Teens who usually interact through social media undoubtedly excel in this area, making them easier to adapt to workplace that involve digital technology.

However, Oddy (2023) discovers that 96.6% of people are more likely to engage in F2F communication. This shows that F2F communication remains important in modern life, even though many shifted some of their communication methods to social media after COVID-19 pandemic. Unfortunately, since young people's reliance on social media gives

them fewer opportunities to practice F2F communication, they may face challenges in meetings and presentations. They often become tense when meeting people and solving problems due to low adaptability and a lack of practice.

8.4 Ways to Balance Social Media Interaction and Face-to-Face Interactions

Consequently, it is crucial for youth to balance their interactions between social media and F2F communication for the effective development of social skills to avoid the problems mention above happen. For example, actively participating in extracurricular activities like clubs and sports, or regularly hanging out with friends, create opportunities for teens to engage in in-personal communication. This allows teenagers to physically interact with people around them, enabling them to practice and develop their real-life social skills.

Meanwhile, teens can consciously use social media in more meaningful ways, such as engaging in thoughtful text conversations rather than just reacting with likes and emojis. This approach can help teens balance their social skills in both social media and F2F settings.

9.0 The Role of Social Media Influencer Marketing in Shaping Teenage Consumer Behavior

With the advent of the digital age, social media platforms have become an important part of the daily life of the teenagers, and the social media influencers are gradually having a profound impact on the consumption behavior of young people. As an important group in the consumer market, the behavior and choices of teenagers not only reflect their personal preferences, but are also shaped and driven by external trends. By showing their own lifestyles, recommending products and sharing experiences, influencers have not only become an important channel for young people to obtain information, but also invisibly guide their consumption decisions.

9.1 Why Teenagers are Influenced by Social Media Influencers in Their Consumption Behavior

9.1.1 Parasocial interaction

Parasocial Interaction (PSI) is a psychological relationship experienced by a viewer when engaging with performers on social media platforms. Audience members begin to perceive public figures as friends, despite having little or no actual interaction with them. PSI is described as an illusory experience, wherein media audiences engage with characters such as social media influencers or celebrities as if they are forming a mutual connection.

Through repeated exposure to media personalities by teenagers, PSI evolves into parasocial relationships that spark interest in social media influencers. This, in turn, creates a sense of friendship, intimacy, and identification among the teenagers. Positive information about social media influencers further increases their appeal, allowing these relationships to develop. One study emphasizes that higher levels of parasocial interaction can enhance stronger parasocial relationships, thereby influencing consumers' attitudes and behaviors. Parasocial relationships are strengthened by the reliance and self-disclosure provided by social media influencers (Zhou et al., 2024). These one-sided connections make teenagers feel personally connected to the influencer, which further influences their purchasing decisions.

9.1.2 Aspirational lifestyle

In recent years, influenced by the glamorous lifestyles showcased by influencers, some young people have developed tendencies for overconsumption. Seeing the luxurious lives of influencers on social media sparks a desire to imitate them, leading to the purchase of goods and services beyond their financial means. Research explores how social media facilitates conspicuous consumption, leading consumers to desire and purchase similar products and services (Efendioğku, 2022). Moreover, as social media usage becomes increasingly widespread, people are frequently exposed to posts depicting these idealized lifestyles, fueling young people's strong desire to pursue such lives.

Why do young people aspire to this lifestyle? Consumption is not just about purchasing tangible items; it is also a way for consumers to showcase who they want to become. In other words, consumers buy products for their symbolic significance (Efendioğku, 2022). Consequently, people want to ensure their social circles can see their glamorous lives. Individuals often categorize their luxury goods, the interesting places they've visited, the

enjoyable moments they've had, and the diverse foods they've eaten as part of a luxurious lifestyle and tend to display this on social media.

For example, an influencer you follow, who is financially well-off, only recommends expensive clothing to her audience. While you cannot afford such items, you strongly desire to own them because it would symbolize that you, too, are living a luxurious life like the influencer. By posting about it in your social circle, you can let others see this image of your life. Thus, you might plead with your parents to buy these expensive clothes for you. This demonstrates how influencers can impact young people's consumption behavior.

9.2 The Impact of Influencers on Teenage Consumes Behavior

9.2.1 Shaping perception of trends

In today's digital age, influencers play a key role in setting trends, especially among teenagers who are highly active on social media platforms. They introduce new products, styles, and even behaviors that quickly become popular among their fans. A study highlights that social media influencers have a significant impact on consumer behavior, especially among younger audiences (Lajnef, 2023). Teenagers are at a stage in their development where social approval and a sense of belonging are crucial, making them particularly susceptible to these trends. Therefore, the style, products or lifestyle presented by influencers often become a guide for teenagers to consume.

For example, an influencer might showcase a new sneaker, a specific skincare product, or a unique way to style something. These products often become symbols of being "in the know" or socially meaningful, prompting teens to buy them to feel included or appreciated. Platforms like TikTok, Instagram, and YouTube amplify this effect due to their visually driven nature and the viral potential of their content. A single post or video can quickly turn a humble product into a must-have among teens.

Additionally, teens often view influencers as reliable role models rather than unattainable celebrities. This trustworthiness leads them to trust influencers' recommendations and emulate their choices. For example, if a beauty influencer posts a tutorial featuring a specific makeup palette, teens are likely to view it as a featured product, aligning their preferences with the advertised product.

This influence can have both positive and negative aspects. On the positive side, influencers can introduce teens to trends that are creative, innovative, or culturally relevant. However, it can also lead to overconsumption, peer pressure, or unrealistic expectations, especially if the trends promoted are expensive or not affordable for all teens. Recognizing this duality, parents, educators, and teens themselves need to critically evaluate influencer content while appreciating its role in shaping modern youth culture.

9.3 Increase Awareness of Different Brands and Products

Social media influencers significantly influence teens' consumption behaviors by introducing them to a variety of brands and products, expanding their range of choices and fostering a more inclusive approach to consumption. Unlike traditional marketing campaigns, which often focus on established or well-known products, influencers use their personal experiences and platforms to highlight unique and diverse choices. These choices may include lesser-known brands, start-ups, or brands that cater to niche markets, allowing teens to explore alternatives that they may not be exposed to through traditional advertising channels.

For example, lifestyle influencers might feature eco-friendly products, sustainable fashion, or handmade goods from small businesses, encouraging teens to consider ethical and environmentally friendly choices. Similarly, beauty influencers often introduce their audiences to inclusive brands that offer products for a variety of skin tones, hair types, or cultural preferences. This exposure not only increases awareness of these brands among teens, but also reinforces the idea that diversity and representation in the marketplace are important.

Besides, influencers often bridge the gap between specific products and mass audiences. By introducing fans to people from different cultural backgrounds, influencers can also foster genuine appreciation and inclusion. For example, travel influencers showcasing cultural products from different countries can inspire teenagers to value and support culturally authentic products.

In addition to expanding the range of choices, influencer recommendations often align with values such as sustainability, ethical production or social impact, which resonate deeply with the socially conscious mindset of Generation Z. By showcasing brands that align with these values to teens, influencers play a crucial role in shaping a new generation of consumers who prioritize mindful and inclusive purchasing decisions. An article highlights how

influencers actively introduce innovative products and ideas to their followers, thereby increasing their understanding and appreciation of various options (*The Impact of Social Media Influencers on Young Minds: Navigating the Positive and Negative Effects*, 2023). This approach not only expands consumer choice, but also helps to create a more inclusive and representative market.

10.0 Conclusion

In conclusion, social media has an undeniable impact on shaping the lifestyle and influencing the mindset of future generations. By focusing on cultural language, social interactions, and beauty ideals. It offers both opportunities and challenges to society. Even though platforms like Instagram, TikTok and Facebook provide global connectivity, cultural exchange and personalized expression. At the same time, it also exacerbates problems such as skewed impressions, mental health problems and losing close friendships and real connection.

In terms of cultural language, social media has fostered the evolution of language but also threatens the cultural diversity as the teenagers adopt the global language style by emphasizing on Eurocentrism. The resulting "mother tongue shame" highlights the importance of fostering cultural confidence and promoting multilingual education to preserve linguistic heritage. In the same way, online communication replacing face to face communication changes social skill development because of overreliance on curated digital communication, less empathy, and ruined ability to adapt in the reality.

Not only that, teenage consumer behavior is becoming increasingly driven by social media influencers, whom teens look to for ways to navigate purchasing decisions in which they seek relatability and aspirational appeal. While bringing in creative and varied options that fit well with modern attitudes, their impact may force problems like overconsumption and unrealism. Through critical engagement with influencer content, teenagers, parents and educators can collectively create a framework to move within the continuously changing digital landscape, ensuring that influencer marketing will become a tool for positive and mindful consumer engagement.

Last but not least, the social media promoted a proliferation of idealised beauty standards can distort self-perception, affecting self-esteem and mental health, especially among impressionable audiences. The emphasis on curated, “perfect” lifestyles can alienate users from their authentic selves, perpetuating insecurities and fostering a cycle of comparison. It’s really important to be aware of these challenges to help people develop their digital literacy, balance the online and offline interaction, and to consume more authentic, inclusive content.

In summary, individuals and society should navigate the complexities of social media responsibly to ensure it becomes a force for positive influence. Future generations can grow up in a digital empowered world with authentic, cultural diversity and real connection by utilizing social media wisely.

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1.0 Introduction

The philosophy of technology emerged after the second industrial revolution in the 19th century. It exists to examine the nature, impact, and ethical implications of technology either good or bad in a society. This research paper will be focused on how social media today gradually shapes people's lifestyles and influences the mindset of future generations. Before the topic goes further, it's essential to have an understanding to social media platforms.

Social media platform is the digital space used for users to connect, share content and interact with people globally. For example, platforms like Instagram, Facebook, TikTok and Twitter allow users to share visual content, even messages for personal expression and community engagement (Dixon, 2022). By helping to create the culture and communication, these platforms would promote the trends, raise virtual communities and spread the information rapidly (Kaplan & Haenlein,2010). Although social media platforms offer such benefits, it also possesses a dark side which should be looked for.

First and foremost, social media plays a massive part in the language aspect. English has dominated social media most, especially among globally influential and creator communities. Despite English being an international language, this dominance has led to the trends that prioritize English over other languages among teenagers, particularly in non-English countries. Over time, this shift can create a sense of shame about using one's mother tongue, especially if it is not seen as 'cool' or 'modern' in the digital world. Society may lose native languages with cultural richness and identity while the teenager is exposed to the language of global influencers and cyber culture. This transformation raises critical questions about the erosion of cultural languages and the potential long-term consequences for teenagers' sense of self and their connection to their cultural heritage (Gundara, 2014).

Besides, social media has transformed the way adolescents interact with each other, particularly in the development of social skills. Face to face (F2F) communication traditionally served as the basis for learning the fundamental social skills of interpreting non-verbal cues, managing emotions and resolving conflicts. Through body language, facial expressions, and tone of voice, individuals can be understood to be engaging in real time F2F conversations. However, teenagers are increasingly exposed to the edited and curated interaction, while the digital interaction replaces the F2F communication. The shift in communication styles has not

only hindered teenagers' ability to read and understand social cues, but it has also prevented teenagers from taking part in real time conflict resolution, critical thinking and improvisational problem solving (Wang, 2024).

In addition, one of the major problems among social media is the impact of the idealised pictures of life and beauty. On platforms like Instagram and TikTok, users always share their best moments in carefully edited photos and videos that are a polished version of their lives. This has created an unrealistic standard of beauty, success and happiness among teenagers which omits the struggles in reality. Since teens see flawless skin, perfect bodies, even perfect lifestyles as they scroll through their feeds, which may lead to negative comparisons and feelings of inadequacy. Therefore, mental health problems like anxiety, depression and low self-esteem are caused by this phenomenon because they will feel under the stress to match up these unrealisable expectations (Vogels et al., 2022).

Moreover, the digital age has changed the way teenagers consume in many ways, and social media influencers have come to be the heroes in this story. Influencers have become young audiences' trusted sources of information, trendsetters, and have been sharing their lifestyles, recommending products and pronouncing personal experiences. Hence, they can create parasocial relationships and show aspirational lifestyles, which have significantly influenced teenagers' purchasing decisions, directly making them important players in the ever-changing consumer market.

In this case, social media impact on teenagers' cultural language, social skills, and mental health is crucial to be explored. This essay will demonstrate through studying the reasons in what ways social media can be beneficial and harmful to teenagers as they endeavour to live in a more modern digital world. Furthermore, this essay also offers recommendations on how to maintain the positive aspects of social media while ensuring the importance of meaningful, real-life interactions for healthy development and wellbeing.

2.0 Research Questions

i. How do various elements of social media shape unrealistic beauty ideals, and in what ways does the difference between carefully curated and unfiltered content influence these ideals?

ii. What impact do idealized images of life on social networks have on people's perceptions of their bodies, mental health and self-esteem, especially when compared to their unadorned reality?

iii. How does social media influence cultural language among teenagers?

iv. How do social media interactions compare to face-to-face interactions in shaping the development of social skills in youth?

v. How do social media influencers impact consumer behaviour and lifestyle choices among teenagers?

3.0 Objectives of Discussion

i. To explore how the elements of social media shape unrealistic beauty ideals and compare the impact of curated content with unfiltered content.

ii. To examine the impact that idealized images of life on social networks have on people's perceptions of their bodies, mental health and self-esteem when compared to their unadorned reality.

iii. To study how social media influences cultural language among teenagers.

iv. To discover how social media interactions compare to face-to-face interactions in shaping the development of social skills in youth.

v. To investigate how social media influencers impact consumer behaviour and lifestyle choices among teenagers.

4.0 Importance of Study

This study is important in understanding how social media affects lifestyles and the perspectives of future generations. Social media has transformed the way that people connect, express, and perceive the world. However, the curated nature that formed by social media often obscures reality. Therefore, it has led to significant psychological consequences, especially on adolescents and young children. Research by Smith and Ander (2022) indicates that popular social media platforms used by most Americans like Instagram and Snapchat, which promote an idealized lifestyle that leads to negative self-comparison. Meanwhile, Khalaf (2023) found that teenages who spend excessive on social media more likely experience anxiety, depression and feelings of inadequacy. According to Twenge, Martin and Spitzberg (2019) also realized that increased digital media usage across the past several decades was associated with declines in adolescent mental health.

In addition to mental health, social media also plays an important role in defining how our society behaves and norms as a whole. There is a study from Wallace 2020, they emphasized on platforms normalising unattainable ideals that "filter culture" has created unrealistic beauty standards, contributing to increased interest in cosmetic procedures. Furthermore, according to a Statista report in 2023, 74% of the users stated to be depending on social media to guide their purchasing decisions, which is proven to be true economically. These trends are troubling in terms of ethical marketing and over consumerism. Given that 95% of teens live with smartphones and use social media daily, its influence on shaping identity, aspirations and values is undeniable (Smith & Anderson, 2018).

It is essential to understand these dynamics for fostering a more media literature culture. Therefore, it will help users think critically and use the digital world wisely. Such programs promoted by UNESCO (2023) are aiming to improve digital literacy as well as helping people to differentiate the curated with authentic narratives. Moreover, it's also provided insights with the policy and regulations regarding topics related to cyberbullying, misinformation, even data privacy. For example, UNESCO's media education tools emphasize on the role of ethical standards and accountability in the digital world.

Last but not least, it is necessary to understand the role of social media influencers in shaping teenage consumption behavior so as to discover how external influencer can affect teenagers when they decide. The central finding of this study is that parasocial interaction and aspirational lifestyles foster teenagers to adopt influencers and trends. Influencers create brand awareness of such varied brands and values as sustainability and cultural appreciation, as they help produce more inclusive and conscious about social society generation of consumers. So, these findings serve as important observations for marketers, parents, and educators to guide them through influencer effects, both negative and positive, on teenage consumption behavior.

In summary, studying the hidden truth of social media is vital for evaluating its dual nature, which contributes as the connection and inspirations or result to insecurities and harmful behaviors. Through informed research and proactive measures, society may minimise the negative impact of social media to ensure that future generations are able to respond to it wisely.

5.0 What is an unrealistic beauty idea?

Unrealistic beauty ideals are the concept of having expectations of how people should look. They more often set a level of perfection that's almost impossible to reach, such as flawless skin, a particular form, or perfectly symmetrical qualities. These ideals can put pressure on people to feel self-abased about what other people are supposed to be and struggle with self-worth or even make poor choices.

5.1 Various Elements of Social Media Shape Unrealistic Beauty Ideals

5.1.1 Advertisement

One of the biggest fuel generators of unrealistic beauty standards on social media platforms is advertisements. Brands and companies spend billions of dollars each year on marketing that designs using airbrushed models and hyper-idealized images to present their products in the most putting-forward way possible.

Also, some brands will use heavily edited images to create a culture where perfection seems normal. For instance, in November 2014, Victoria's Secret launched its "Perfect Body"

campaign, featuring ten models who looked strikingly similar in body shape and size. The campaign sparked criticism for promoting a narrow view of beauty and lacking body diversity. Many were also frustrated with how the company misled consumers about the models' appearances, which were digitally altered (Bahadur, 2017). The advertisements continue to perpetuate a culture of perfection that does not account for diversity in what a human body looks like, what a skin tone should be, or what their personal experience is. Even though people are aware that such images are edited, the constant exposure still makes these ideals seem desirable. Beyond this, it causes dissatisfaction with one's own body and encourages actions like extreme dieting, compulsive exercising, and even cosmetic surgeries in hopes of achieving these unrealistic standards.

To truly deal with these harmful standards, a collective effort is essential. The Dove Campaign for Real Beauty is an example of how advertising can promote more inclusive beauty ideals. This global campaign showcases unedited images of women with diverse body types and skin tones, encouraging people to embrace their natural beauty and celebrate authenticity (Weissbrot et al., n.d.). Studies support the positive impact of these initiatives—Hutt (2024) reported that the campaign helped participants develop a greater appreciation for diverse beauty and improved their self-esteem, reducing anxiety about their appearance.

5.1.2 Editing photo application

With the popularity of photo editing apps, like Photoshop, Facetune, and Instagram and Snapchat filters, anyone with a smartphone can change how they look. What once only applied to professional photos is now required usage on our everyday social media pages, where manipulated images have become more the norm than the exception. A photo is easy to enhance—smoothing skin, reshaping features, or adding a "healthy glow" to a photo—it makes us exist in a world where 'perfect' is attainable and "real" seems inadequate.

A survey by the Feragen (2014) found that 50% of social media users edit their photos before sharing them on platforms like Facebook, Instagram, and Twitter. This is because almost every platform has built-in editing tools these days, making the line blur between reality and fantasy more and more with every click of the mouse (Henriques & Patnaik, 2020). People who see such idealized photos by influencers and celebrities tend to treat the photos like things that should be followed. Their compulsion to modify their photos to meet the beauty standards showcased in the pictures of the influencers and celebrities. According to a University of London study, 90% of young women reported using filters or editing before posting photos to

alter their appearance (Wyk, 2021). The problem with this is that the images people see online are routinely manipulated, and normalized digitally; rarely are they accurate depictions of reality, but rather highly curated and over-produced depictions in an attempt to meet unattainable ideals.

This, in turn, breeds a collective mentality that natural beauty is not enough, and that to be the so-called 'perfect' version of oneself, can only be achieved by altering oneself digitally. Not only does it change people's thoughts on how they portray themselves online, but it also manipulates their natural selves offline. This places pressure on us to become digital conformists, refusing to accept our natural imperfections and further mental health issues including anxiety and depression.

5.1.3 Celebrity influence

Social media plays a central role in advancing and keeping the ideal of unrealistic and unrealistic beauty via celebrities. Having a large number of supporters, they are role models for many people; young people often aspire to celebrities for inspiration on how they look, how they should be living, and include personal values. The world of celebrities is highly curated and extremely controlled, which means they present themselves in a wonderful way like perfect bodies, flawless skin, and enviable lives. What people easily forget is that it is a blend of professional styling, makeup, lighting, personal trainers, and maybe even cosmetic surgeries. - The Kardashians are a prominent example of this—they've built an empire on promoting highly curated and altered versions of themselves, convincing young women that their appearances are simply the result of workouts and healthy diets. In reality, their looks are enhanced by surgeries, cosmetic procedures, and photo editing (Hafeez & Zulfiqar, 2023). Also, Essena O'Neill, an Australian influencer, admitted that her popular Instagram photos were heavily edited to make her look more attractive, and she eventually quit social media, revealing the pressures behind influencer culture (BBC, 2015).

And the result is a twisted sense of beauty and self-worth. Young women, more than almost anyone else, are made to feel that they have to look like their favourite celebrity to be considered attractive or valuable. A study involving 227 female university students showed that many women compare their appearance to that of celebrities not to family members, often negatively when browsing Facebook (Fardouly & Vartanian, 2015). If we do not control these feelings, we will lead to harmful behaviors, like wanting cosmetic surgery, taking unhealthy diet pills, and being on superstitious fitness routines. Thus, celebrities' influence is

spread beyond admiration, it changes the way people see themselves, and causes unhealthy comparisons that result in being destructive not only to mental but also to physical well-being.

5.2 Curated 'Fake' Lifestyles vs. Hidden Realities

Social media is a space for people to share only the best parts: the best parts of our lives, the best angles, and the most exciting adventures. As users scroll through, users are bombarded with images of slim, toned bodies, glowing skin, and seemingly perfect lives. These visuals are often edited to erase imperfections and enhance features, creating a distorted view of reality. Oftentimes the struggles, the imperfections, the challenges that everybody will face, are what is left out. This is created by influencers, celebrities, and even regular users who create their online presence to showcase only the highlights of their lives. then people share only the best part of their lives online, the gap between the perfect image they choose to share online compared to what they don't is amplified.

This makes for a huge impact on the audience of curation because we cannot escape from using social media. Platforms like Instagram play a crucial role in shaping beauty standards. It is because over 95 million photos are shared on Instagram daily, and Instagram has become a main contributor to public beauty standards (Franchina & Coco, 2018). This shows that unhealthy comparisons and dissatisfaction manifest themselves in a never-ending stream of seemingly perfect lives. We start to think about our true worth compared to the highlights curated by others online which are frequently not the whole image.

6.0 Impact that Idealized Images of Life on Social Networks Have on People's Perceptions When Compared to Their Unadorned Reality

The advent of social networks has significantly changed people's view of their bodies, encouraging a standardized standard of beauty and attractiveness that focuses on limited and often unattainable norms (Merino et al., 2024).

Idealized images of people on social networks have a deep psychological effect, affecting how people look at their bodies, mental health and self-esteem. Constant exposure to carefully selected content can cause the comparison itself, which can cause anxiety and a sense of inadequacy. These photos often distort reality, which makes people feel alienated from who

they really are and fuels dissatisfaction with the body. The assimilation of these ideals can negatively affect mental health, reduce self-esteem and develop unrealistic expectations for life and beauty.

6.1 Impact on Mental Health

Idealized images on social media have a significant negative impact on mental health and can lead to conditions such as depression and body dysmorphic disorder (Bülow, 2023).

6.1.1 Depression

Constant self-comparison can lead to depression, which is characterized by unhappiness, hopelessness and disinterest in daily activities.

According to The Clinical Committee (2019), more depression was significantly correlated with an increase in social media participation. The study showed that 29% of people who used social networks at least 58 times a week had high symptoms of depression, while only 19% of people who used them 8 or less times a week had such symptoms. Vise versa, 36% of those who attended fewer sessions reported having mild depressive symptoms, while only 16% of those who attended 58 or more sessions per week.

6.1.2 Body Dysmorphic Disorder (BDD)

Since social networking sites such as Instagram often include idealized, carefully selected photos that support unattainable beauty standards, social networks have made a significant contribution to the aggravation of BDD. Especially for teenagers and young people who still form a sense of their own movement, these exquisite and filtered photos can lead to serious self-comparisons. People who regularly encounter such photos may learn these standards and become more dissatisfied with how they look.

Consequently, people with BDD can look for cosmetic surgery to "correct" what they consider defects. Cosmetic procedures, however, are unlikely to ever reduce the psychological suffering caused by the disease.

6.2 Impact on Self-Esteem

According to Dr. Richelle Mayshak from the School of Psychology at Deakin University (Mayshak, 2018), social networking sites such as Facebook and Instagram have the potential to spread idealized images, which can lead to low self-esteem. Ahe mentioned that social comparisons and feelings of unpopularity, for example, when messages do not receive the expected number of likes, are often the causes of these bad emotions. This shows how social networks can have a psychological impact on people, especially when it comes to encouraging inability and unreasonable expectations. Furthermore, 20% of adults and most adolescents suffer from dissatisfaction with their body because of social networks, as they often contrast their own lives with carefully groomed, idealized images of others. Adolescents are particularly at risk, as the constant exposure to these idealized images often has a detrimental effect on their developing sense of self and body image (Krzymowski, 2024).

In addition, this dynamic contributes to a feeling of inferiority and jealousy, as individuals compare themselves to the content online. Social media like Instagram compound this problem by displaying aesthetically pleasing but unattainable content that feeds users' self-doubt and perfectionist tendencies. Widespread discontent and a sense of separation from the true self are the results.

6.3 Unrealistic Expectations for Life and Beauty

The distorted view of reality is caused by unrealistic expectations of life and beauty, which are influenced by representation of romanticized ideas on social networks. Social media networks usually show carefully selected examples of success, achievement and lifestyle perfection, setting impossible standards. These images are often devoid of context and mention the shortcomings and difficulties that arise with the human being.

This emphasis on perfection contributes to the idea that success and beauty have limited definitions, which encourages people to strive for these impractical ideals. In addition to distorting reality, the emphasis on material achievements and digitally improved aesthetics promotes a culture of comparison. As a result, people are under pressure to fit in because of these dynamics, which fuels a vicious circle of discontent and pursuit of impossible goals (Cleveland Clinic, 2023).

6.4 Real Examples in Gender-Specific Beauty Pressures

While social media platforms have tacitly amplified unrealistic beauty standards, the nature and impact of these pressures vary across genders. We start to think about our true worth compared to the highlights curated by others online which are frequently not the whole image. This has such a psychological impact, that people get to believe their own lives are not complete because they are not like the perfection they see on social media. Adolescence is a vulnerable period for body dissatisfaction in social media—half of boys and 74% of girls at age 14 wish they could change something about their bodies, leading to issues like poor self-esteem and eating disorders (Vuong et al., 2021). This shows that people will experience anxiety, depression, and feelings of alienation because people think they are not enough compared to others.

For girls, the ideals are almost universally about being feminine, and that usually relates to looking perfect – flawless skin, youthful features, and a slim body. Girls are often told to make themselves look prettier through makeup, cosmetic procedures, and clothing options that supplement their 'ideal' body. In recent years, around the time filters and other augmented reality (AR) tools that alter facial and body features became widely popular, offering users an easy way to 'perfect' their looks. While these tools are marketed as empowering enhancements, they can often create new and unattainable standards of beauty. This is because filters even will make the most natural, untouched features look inadequate, creating almost impossible dissonance between real and ideal beauty. This false representation creates a large sense of insecurity around people who are comparing themselves to these edited, perfectly flawless pictures that they see.

Social media puts equal pressure, and in different ways, on boys. Social media influencers of the fitness industry are perpetuating an unrealistic idea of what masculinity is all about which it should be extreme muscularity and low body fat. Hypermasculine physiques are often pushed by the successful influencers in the fitness world, many of whom espouse unattainable body types, necessary to achieve through extreme exercise regimens and unrealistic dieting. It is these ideals that have convinced so many young men that their worth is linked straight to their physical appearance. Achieving the ‘perfect’ body comes with unrealistic and pressure-filled due to this, it is not only harmful but also often dangerous. Griffiths et al. (2019) found in a 2019 study hyper exposure to ideal male physiques on social media led to 60% of young men reporting body dissatisfaction. This expectation is additionally

a factor in increased charges of body discontent and sick practices among men, from the utilization of steroids and enhancements to the utilization of extreme wellness regimens that can prompt poor well-being.

Additionally, social media sites frequently push trends like 'six-pack abs,' 'Greek god physique,' and so on things that many men will never be able to achieve from a genetic standpoint or due to their lifestyle circumstances. There is a danger that can lead to feelings of inadequacy, frustration, and low self-esteem, and ultimately to the use of high-risk behavior including over-training or the misuse of performance-enhancing substances. According to Nadine Palmer (2024), there exists pressure on young men to meet these ideals, leaving many to believe that they are worthy tied to their physical appearance, leading to feeling negative about themselves and potentially practicing dangerous acts.

This becomes a bigger issue when social media is flooded with 'perfect' bodies - both male and female - without showing how real life is. Rather, most of the time, behind the polished images are realities about excessive time spent on grooming, makeup, styling hair, and editing the photos to fit the ideal. The difference between online curated, 'fake' lifestyles and real lives or more imperfect realities that people experience creates feelings of isolation and disappointment. This kind of unrealistic beauty tendency to demand them to live up to often unrealized ideals contributes to the difficulty of individuals accepting their natural bodies and leads to a bad cycle of self-criticism and low self-esteem.

In brief, people's views on their body, mental health and self-esteem are strongly influenced by idealized images on social media platforms. The rise of depression and reduced self-esteem are the result of frequent promotion of these platforms of unrealistic ideals of success and attractiveness. This type of exposure increases anxiety, aggravates dissatisfaction with the body and can lead to serious diseases, including dysmorphic body disorder and depression. Because of their increased impressionability and susceptibility to the requirements of curatorial perfection, teenagers and young people especially suffer. Promoting digital literacy, encouraging diverse and realistic images and developing positive relationships with social networks are essential to counter these consequences.

7.0 How Does Social Media Influence Cultural Language Among Teenagers?

With the development of technology, teenagers nowadays are different from the past. The cheapest smartphones in Malaysia are priced are only cost for RM 499, making them more affordable for parents to buy for their teens (Top 20 Best Budget Phones In Malaysia, 2024). According to study from Vogels et al. (2022), 95% of teenagers in the United States own their smartphones in 2022, compared to 73% in 2014-2015. The increasing use of smartphones among teenagers allows them to connect with social media and gain a sense of the world, as the internet connects everyone. Through contact with the world, teenagers might be influenced by their own culture, including their language acquisition.

7.1 Impact of Cultural Language on Teenagers

The problem of Eurocentrism is still happening in this world. This ideology refers to the supremacy of Western culture, including values, beliefs, and even languages. It results in a biased interpretation of non-European history and culture, framing them solely from a Western perspective and often deeming Western civilization as inherently superior. For example, this ideology suggests the idea that everyone must learn English and make it the Lingua Franca, leading to the sacrifice of mother tongues. Although nowadays most people no longer follow this ideology, it still lingers. For instance, the education system, such as universities, reflects this. Also, when people travel, English is often the default center of communication (Yadav, 2023). With this phenomenon, it causes problems like ‘mother tongue shame.’

7.1.1 Mother tongue shame

Mother tongue shame among teenagers is common because most of them think their mother tongue is “lame.” Due to the development of adolescence, teenagers are sensitive and require attention from their peers (Bergman, 2023). Teenagers want to be unique, but they also want to fit in with the group. For example, a blogger, Yaldaz Sadakova, shared that in school, he only told his friends about his favorite aspects of his own culture, but he did not want to attract too much attention from others because he was one of the few people of his ethnicity in the school (Sadakova, 2024).

7.1.2 Social media are increasing teenagers' shame about their mother tongue

The rise of social media makes it easier for teenagers to share information. Platforms like Instagram and TikTok are mostly in English, and this could affect their mindset, making them think in a Eurocentric way. This is because a lot of the content is in English, and their immature mindset, along with the desire to be unique and fit in with a group, makes them believe in it. The influencers are using certain language, mostly English, to build connections with teenagers by using slang, puns, and trends to change their behavior, which may affect language use (Prudencio et al., 2023). For example, a teenager's peers are constantly using slang from social media influencers. Everybody is doing the same, and in order to fit into the group, it makes the teenagers imitate and stay focused on trends on social media. This idea reinforces the concept of Eurocentrism for teenagers, making them think English is superior to their own language.

7.2 Social Media Changes Teenagers' Language Acquisition"

The Eurocentrism on social media increases teenagers' language acquisition. The more teenagers use English as the main language on social media platforms, the more they are influenced, such as changing their behavior. For instance, teenagers who tend to speak English are more likely to use apps like Discord or Telegram. This is because the community encourages them to do so, as Europeans use these tools rather than Weibo or WeChat, which are for non-English primary languages. Teenagers impacted by this tend to speak English when they are in public or with friends. Thus, it might cause them to lose connection with their mother tongue, along with their cultural and local identity.

7.3 Intervention of Teenager's Multilingualism

With the rapid spread of information, many more people have realized what is happening among teenagers. By leveraging teenagers' natural tendency to use social media, more and more trends, hashtags, or viral videos are appearing on their For You page as they fear missing out on the video (Bergman, 2023). Here's an example: Ping Zhi (@imcpz), the Malaysian TikTok influencer, uses humour to transmit cultural language to the audience (Zhi, 2021). By mispronouncing words and using hashtags like #malaysiatiktok, #mispronouncingwords, and #malaysian, he makes the TikTok algorithm recommend the video

to the local audience and build a strong connection. This resonates with teenagers who struggle with mother tongue shame and English usage. These kinds of trends help reinforce the idea that their mother language is not shameful. Since teenagers often idolize influencers, local influencers who play with accents and mispronunciations are more likely to help reduce the shame associated with using their mother tongue.

7.3.1 Cultural confidence

The example given above provides a sense for teens that their mother language is nothing to be ashamed of. The change in cultural language among teenagers is also caused by cultural confidence. Cultural confidence refers to people who are proud and confident in their own culture, including beliefs, art, literature, ideas, and language (White, 1999b). With cultural confidence, teens are unlikely to be influenced by social media. It allows teenagers to have an open mind toward multilingualism, leading them to feel confident in their own mother tongue, and it also helps them develop self-confidence (Vermander, 2023).

7.4 Multilingual Education in Schools

Other than fostering cultural confidence, schools play an important role in guiding teens toward inspiration. Nowadays, many schools have realized the importance of multilingual education for students. They offer bilingual programs. The school programs focus on two languages: English and the mother tongue. For example, secondary schools in Malaysia offer many languages for students, such as English, Bahasa Melayu, Tamil, and Chinese. It allows students to keep learning English and Malay, but also their mother tongues, Tamil and Chinese (Jeevita, 2024). Although it might give some stress to the students, it is a way to maintain the students' cultural roots. With the intervention of schools, it is more likely to reinforce the idea of globalization rather than the idea of Eurocentrism, making teens less likely to be influenced by social media content.

8.0 Shaping social skills in youth: Social media interactions vs. face-to-face interactions

Social skills are essential for communication as they help in build relationship, solve problems and express emotions (Castelán, 2023). Due to the advancements in technology, people have gradually shifted the primary mode of conversation from face-to-face interactions into social media interactions. This transformation significantly affects how youth develop social skills because of the substantial differences between these forms of interaction.

8.1 Face-to-Face (F2F) Interactions

In real life, F2F conversation occur when two or more people meet each other physically. These conversations often leading individuals to greatly know how is the emotion of the other party through the pick-up of non-verbal cues, which are human facial expression, body gesture, tone of voice and eye contact. F2F conversation prevent misunderstandings, allowing people to clarify messages in real time without delayed as what social media may require when the other party is not online. (Maggie Wooll, 2024)

Besides, F2F conversation require people to think quickly in giving real-time responses. For instance, when resolving conflicts with teammate regarding the different opinion in group work, individuals need to brainstorm and provide credible reason as soon as possible to support the point and prevent the discussion drive into worse situation. Therefore, usually interact through F2F enable youth to adapt with the sudden situations that may occur, as gradually practise help youth to become a better version of self that can cope with emergency situations or problems.

However, study from Lenhart (2015) found out that 72% of teenagers prefer to interact with friends through social media rather than F2F communication. The implement of social media make youth gradually transform their communication preference into an indirect social media communication.

8.2 Why Do Teenagers Choose Social Media Over Face-to-Face Communication?

8.2.1 Strengthens long-distance relationships

Social media allows individuals to interact with friends at any time, from any places, as long as they have mobile devices and internet access. This accessibility enables

individuals to maintain the relationship with friends that not in a same location through posted information of their interest or shared opinions with friends. Regarding the survey from Anderson & Jiang (2018), 81% of youth reported that social media stay them connected with friends, enabling teens to share the same topic and understanding although they have long time did not meet each other.

8.2.2 Enable selectively self-present

According to Walther's Hyperpersonal Model, computer-mediated communication (CMC), including social media, allow individuals build relationships that are highly personal and closer than face-to-face (F2F) interactions. Through social media, youth can selectively present themselves in a way that aligns with how they wish to be shown in public, it means users can set their own characteristic while communicating with others. Unlike F2F communication, social media interactions do not specifically require revealing all personal details or physical appearance. Hence, people can control which preferred cues they choose to send and thereby impress others. (Relationships: Virtual relationships, 2018)

It is good when social media have low presence of non-verbal cues, as youths can control what preferable cues, they are likely to share. This control will make the relationship closer, as the limited cues projected by the communication partner lead the receiver to "fill in the gaps" about what they don't know about the partner, and often idealizing and assuming positive personalities of sender.

8.2.3 Provide more time for message crafting

Compare to face-to-face interactions, which demand immediate response, social media enables individuals to "revise, edit and perfect" their messages before sending them, allowing users to send the message that are more polished and may better fulfil the expectations of the other party. Therefore, it avoids embarrassing errors that may make them regrets.

8.3 Effects of Real-Life Social Skills on Teenagers who Over-Reliance on Social Media

8.3.1 Less confidence

The habit of curating content and crafting response leaves teenagers to feel less confident and unprepared when in real-life conversations. According to Ehmke (2024), teens who heavily rely on social media often feel anxious during F2F direct

communication because they are over-reliance on the communication that not in real-life. Hence, they unable to express themselves naturally when people talk to them. The lack of real-life experiences made them fear to cope with the situation, as there is no space for "revise or edit" their spoken words.

Also, social media limits the chances for teenagers to learn quick thinking, leading to a situation that many can express their opinion very fluent on social media but turn into real-life, he or she becomes frozen and cannot convey their feeling naturally just like what they did online. The social media often provide space for individual to promote their idealize self, which make a big difference when turn into real-life conversation, where there no place to hide imperfections. When time goes by, teenagers might withdraw to have real-life conversations.

8.3.2 Reduce Empathy

Empathy is an emotive ability to understand and share other's feelings, it will gradually shape when one's grown up (Borba, 2016). Non-verbal cues such as facial expression and tone of voice are crucial elements for teens to empathize other's feeling. Whereas, social media, platforms with lower presence of non-verbal cues, make teens face challenges in reading people emotions in physical situation.

Moreover, the "perfect" portrayals often seen on social media encourage youth to see people in a simple way by neglecting the complexity of the real emotion and struggles. This lack of practices in understand real emotion leading them to face difficulties in understanding and resonating with others feeling in F2F settings. Over time, it increases the risk of self-isolation and reduce teens' ability to empathize. (Troomi, 2023)

8.3.3 Long-Term Implications for Future Generations: Workplace Communication

When teens who heavily reliance on social media interactions grow up , it can lead to both benefit and disadvantage situation in the work setting.

Base on the statistics provided by Krook (2024), 92% of today's jobs require digital social skills. Teens who usually interact through social media undoubtedly excel in this area, making them easier to adapt to workplace that involve digital technology.

However, Oddy (2023) discovers that 96.6% of people are more likely to engage in F2F communication. This shows that F2F communication remains important in modern life, even though many shifted some of their communication methods to social media after COVID-19 pandemic. Unfortunately, since young people's reliance on social media gives

them fewer opportunities to practice F2F communication, they may face challenges in meetings and presentations. They often become tense when meeting people and solving problems due to low adaptability and a lack of practice.

8.4 Ways to Balance Social Media Interaction and Face-to-Face Interactions

Consequently, it is crucial for youth to balance their interactions between social media and F2F communication for the effective development of social skills to avoid the problems mention above happen. For example, actively participating in extracurricular activities like clubs and sports, or regularly hanging out with friends, create opportunities for teens to engage in in-personal communication. This allows teenagers to physically interact with people around them, enabling them to practice and develop their real-life social skills.

Meanwhile, teens can consciously use social media in more meaningful ways, such as engaging in thoughtful text conversations rather than just reacting with likes and emojis. This approach can help teens balance their social skills in both social media and F2F settings.

9.0 The Role of Social Media Influencer Marketing in Shaping Teenage Consumer Behavior

With the advent of the digital age, social media platforms have become an important part of the daily life of the teenagers, and the social media influencers are gradually having a profound impact on the consumption behavior of young people. As an important group in the consumer market, the behavior and choices of teenagers not only reflect their personal preferences, but are also shaped and driven by external trends. By showing their own lifestyles, recommending products and sharing experiences, influencers have not only become an important channel for young people to obtain information, but also invisibly guide their consumption decisions.

9.1 Why Teenagers are Influenced by Social Media Influencers in Their Consumption Behavior

9.1.1 Parasocial interaction

Parasocial interaction (PSI) is a psychological relationship experienced by a viewer when engaging with performers on social media platforms. Audience members begin to perceive public figures as friends, despite having little or no actual interaction with them. PSI is described as an illusory experience, wherein media audiences engage with characters such as social media influencers or celebrities as if they are forming a mutual connection.

Through repeated exposure to media personalities by teenagers, PSI evolves into parasocial relationships that spark interest in social media influencers. This, in turn, creates a sense of friendship, intimacy, and identification among the teenagers. Positive information about social media influencers further increases their appeal, allowing these relationships to develop. One study emphasizes that higher levels of parasocial interaction can enhance stronger parasocial relationships, thereby influencing consumers' attitudes and behaviors. Parasocial relationships are strengthened by the reliance and self-disclosure provided by social media influencers (Zhou et al., 2024). These one-sided connections make teenagers feel personally connected to the influencer, which further influences their purchasing decisions.

9.1.2 Aspirational lifestyle

In recent years, influenced by the glamorous lifestyles showcased by influencers, some young people have developed tendencies for overconsumption. Seeing the luxurious lives of influencers on social media sparks a desire to imitate them, leading to the purchase of goods and services beyond their financial means. Research explores how social media facilitates conspicuous consumption, leading consumers to desire and purchase similar products and services (Efendioğku, 2022). Moreover, as social media usage becomes increasingly widespread, people are frequently exposed to posts depicting these idealized lifestyles, fueling young people's strong desire to pursue such lives.

Why do young people aspire to this lifestyle? Consumption is not just about purchasing tangible items; it is also a way for consumers to showcase who they want to become. In other words, consumers buy products for their symbolic significance (Efendioğku, 2022). Consequently, people want to ensure their social circles can see their glamorous lives. Individuals often categorize their luxury goods, the interesting places they've visited, the

enjoyable moments they've had, and the diverse foods they've eaten as part of a luxurious lifestyle and tend to display this on social media.

For example, an influencer you follow, who is financially well-off, only recommends expensive clothing to her audience. While you cannot afford such items, you strongly desire to own them because it would symbolize that you, too, are living a luxurious life like the influencer. By posting about it in your social circle, you can let others see this image of your life. Thus, you might plead with your parents to buy these expensive clothes for you. This demonstrates how influencers can impact young people's consumption behavior.

9.2 The Impact of Influencers on Teenage Consumes Behavior

9.2.1 Shaping perception of trends

In today's digital age, influencers play a key role in setting trends, especially among teenagers who are highly active on social media platforms. They introduce new products, styles, and even behaviors that quickly become popular among their fans. A study highlights that social media influencers have a significant impact on consumer behavior, especially among younger audiences (Lajnef, 2023). Teenagers are at a stage in their development where social approval and a sense of belonging are crucial, making them particularly susceptible to these trends. Therefore, the style, products or lifestyle presented by influencers often become a guide for teenagers to consume.

For example, an influencer might showcase a new sneaker, a specific skincare product, or a unique way to style something. These products often become symbols of being "in the know" or socially meaningful, prompting teens to buy them to feel included or appreciated. Platforms like TikTok, Instagram, and YouTube amplify this effect due to their visually driven nature and the viral potential of their content. A single post or video can quickly turn a humble product into a must-have among teens.

Additionally, teens often view influencers as reliable role models rather than unattainable celebrities. This trustworthiness leads them to trust influencers' recommendations and emulate their choices. For example, if a beauty influencer posts a tutorial featuring a specific makeup palette, teens are likely to view it as a featured product, aligning their preferences with the advertised product.

This influence can have both positive and negative aspects. On the positive side, influencers can introduce teens to trends that are creative, innovative, or culturally relevant. However, it can also lead to overconsumption, peer pressure, or unrealistic expectations, especially if the trends promoted are expensive or not affordable for all teens. Recognizing this duality, parents, educators, and teens themselves need to critically evaluate influencer content while appreciating its role in shaping modern youth culture.

9.3 Increase Awareness of Different Brands and Products

Social media influencers significantly influence teens' consumption behaviors by introducing them to a variety of brands and products, expanding their range of choices and fostering a more inclusive approach to consumption. Unlike traditional marketing campaigns, which often focus on established or well-known products, influencers use their personal experiences and platforms to highlight unique and diverse choices. These choices may include lesser-known brands, start-ups, or brands that cater to niche markets, allowing teens to explore alternatives that they may not be exposed to through traditional advertising channels.

For example, lifestyle influencers might feature eco-friendly products, sustainable fashion, or handmade goods from small businesses, encouraging teens to consider ethical and environmentally friendly choices. Similarly, beauty influencers often introduce their audiences to inclusive brands that offer products for a variety of skin tones, hair types, or cultural preferences. This exposure not only increases awareness of these brands among teens, but also reinforces the idea that diversity and representation in the marketplace are important.

Besides, influencers often bridge the gap between specific products and mass audiences. By introducing fans to people from different cultural backgrounds, influencers can also foster genuine appreciation and inclusion. For example, travel influencers showcasing cultural products from different countries can inspire teenagers to value and support culturally authentic products.

In addition to expanding the range of choices, influencer recommendations often align with values such as sustainability, ethical production or social impact, which resonate deeply with the socially conscious mindset of Generation Z. By showcasing brands that align with these values to teens, influencers play a crucial role in shaping a new generation of consumers who prioritize mindful and inclusive purchasing decisions. An article highlights how

influencers actively introduce innovative products and ideas to their followers, thereby increasing their understanding and appreciation of various options (*The Impact of Social Media Influencers on Young Minds: Navigating the Positive and Negative Effects*, 2023). This approach not only expands consumer choice, but also helps to create a more inclusive and representative market.

10.0 Conclusion

In conclusion, social media has an undeniable impact on shaping the lifestyle and influencing the mindset of future generations. By focusing on cultural language, social interactions, and beauty ideals. It offers both opportunities and challenges to society. Even though platforms like Instagram, TikTok and Facebook provide global connectivity, cultural exchange and personalized expression. At the same time, it also exacerbates problems such as skewed impressions, mental health problems and losing close friendships and real connection.

In terms of cultural language, social media has fostered the evolution of language but also threatens the cultural diversity as the teenagers adopt the global language style by emphasizing on Eurocentrism. The resulting "mother tongue shame" highlights the importance of fostering cultural confidence and promoting multilingual education to preserve linguistic heritage. In the same way, online communication replacing face to face communication changes social skill development because of overreliance on curated digital communication, less empathy, and ruined ability to adapt in the reality.

Not only that, teenage consumer behavior is becoming increasingly driven by social media influencers, whom teens look to for ways to navigate purchasing decisions in which they seek relatability and aspirational appeal. While bringing in creative and varied options that fit well with modern attitudes, their impact may force problems like overconsumption and unrealism. Through critical engagement with influencer content, teenagers, parents and educators can collectively create a framework to move within the continuously changing digital landscape, ensuring that influencer marketing will become a tool for positive and mindful consumer engagement.

Last but not least, the social media promoted a proliferation of idealised beauty standards can distort self-perception, affecting self-esteem and mental health, especially among impressionable audiences. The emphasis on curated, "perfect" lifestyles can alienate users from their authentic selves, perpetuating insecurities and fostering a cycle of comparison. It's really important to be aware of these challenges to help people develop their digital literacy, balance the online and offline interaction, and to consume more authentic, inclusive content.

In summary, individuals and society should navigate the complexities of social media responsibly to ensure it becomes a force for positive influence. Future generations can grow up in a digital empowered world with authentic, cultural diversity and real connection by utilizing social media wisely.

5X+1Y Group 7 Content.pdf

ORIGINALITY REPORT

3%	2%	0%	2%
SIMILARITY INDEX	INTERNET SOURCES	PUBLICATIONS	STUDENT PAPERS

PRIMARY SOURCES

1	Submitted to Xiamen University Student Paper	1%
2	Submitted to Leicester College Student Paper	1%
3	finmodelslab.com Internet Source	<1%
4	David Ramírez Plascencia, Barbara Carvalho Gurgel, Avery Plaw. "The Politics of Technology in Latin America (Volume 2) - Digital Media, Daily Life and Public Engagement", Routledge, 2020 Publication	<1%
5	Submitted to Far Eastern University Student Paper	<1%
6	techniumscience.com Internet Source	<1%
7	Submitted to Pennsylvania State System of Higher Education Student Paper	<1%

8	www.coursehero.com Internet Source	<1%

Exclude quotes	On	Exclude matches	< 10 words
Exclude bibliography	On		

The marking rubric must be included in the assignment submission. Please use the current marking rubric provided for this semester.

APPENDIX 1

SCORING RUBRICS
(PHILOSOPHY AS A WAY OF LIFE)

Component Title	Part 1 (Written assignment)- 100 marks				Percentage (%)	30%
Criteria	Score and Descriptors					Marks
	Excellent (9-10)	Good (7-8)	Average (5-6)	Need Improvement (3-4)	Poor (0-2)	
Introduction	A comprehensive introduction complies with the requirements of the introduction, which explains the ideas of the discussion based on the research question.	The introduction complies with an introduction's requirements with adequate explanation based on the research question.	The introduction gives a general explanation of the topic discussed but only briefly describes the research question.	The introduction is related to the topic but has too general explanation related to the topic discussed/ no explanation related to the research question.	There is no introduction provided/ introduction given is not related to the theme/with no details provided/ only a short introduction with no relation to the discussion.	
	(5)	(4)	(3)	(2)	(0-1)	
Research question	The research questions are clearly stated and critical to be discussed.	There are adequate research questions based on the topic given.	The research questions are too general but still relevant to the topic given.	The research questions were given but not enough to cover the topic discussed.	No research question /The question given cannot be considered a research question.	
Objective of the paper work	Objectives are precisely stated that connect with the essential points that comply with the research questions.	Objectives are comprehensible, although not all points stated comply with the research questions.	The objective may not be clearly stated, but it still complies with the research questions.	Objectives may not be clearly stated, and only some comply with the research questions.	No objective stated/ too few comply with the research questions.	
The significance of the study	A precise explanation of the component is given, with critical reasons elaborated for the issues related to the topic discussed.	An adequate explanation of the components is given, but there is no critical reason for the issues related to the topic discussed.	The explanation about the components is stated but does not show the critical reason for covering the content discussed.	The explanation of the components given is too general and not specific to the purpose of the study.	There is no significance of the study included / only one or two points, which do not show the relation to the research question and the study's objective.	
	(9-10)	(7-8)	(5-6)	(3-4)	(1-2)	
Organization	It is both accurate and compelling. The writing begins with an interesting or provocative introduction that contains a clear and concise explanation of the topic discussed. The body fully explores the topic and presents information in a sensible order. Transitions are used consistently.	The writing begins with a clear introduction to introduce the topic discussed. All required components are discussed adequately. The body explores the topic and presents information in a sensible order. Transitions are used consistently.	The writing begins with an introduction that contains a detailed research question, objectives, and significance of studies. The body explores the topic and presents information in a sensible order. Transitions are used, but they still lack consistency.	The writing begins with an introduction that contains an explanation but needs to be longer and needs more explanation and clarification. The body explores the topic and presents some ideas. However, it needs to be more coherent between one point and another/ Transitions can be used inconsistently or lacking in many ways.	It is generally confusing and hard to follow. The writing lacks any real organization, and no topic explanation is given. The body presents support that may be related to the topic but only in a general way/ The organization is poor or nonexistent.	

	(13-15)	(10-12)	(7-9)	(4-6)	(3-1)	
Content	Accomplished purposes of the assignment directly and entirely in an exceptional manner. The latest and specific, accurate, relevant data thoroughly support all significant topics.	Accomplished purposes of the assignment directly and entirely in an adequate manner. Some example thoroughly supports all major topic. However, the explanation is somewhat lacking in specificity and lacks accuracy, relevant and current data.	Accomplished assignments in a capable manner. Major topics were covered, but supporting details are general and lack accurate references, especially examples.	Accomplished assignments in a capable manner. Significant topics covered but supporting details somewhat lacking in specificity, accuracy, or reference/ too general/ no example presented to support the discussion/ explanation is too general.	The content of the assignments only partially or indirectly accomplished the paper's objective. Little or no supporting data or data presented was not relevant, specific, or accurate.	
Relevancy of philosophical ideas.	The discussion demonstrates the student's understanding, provides ideas, and explains the philosophical ideas that are accurately relevant to the discussion.	The discussion demonstrates the student's understanding, and there are applications of the philosophical concepts learned in the course.	The discussion demonstrates the student's understanding to a certain extent, and there are applications of the philosophical concepts learned in the course.	The discussion does not demonstrate the student's understanding but less application of the philosophical concept learned in the course.	The discussion does not demonstrate the student's understanding and no application of the philosophical concept learned in the course.	
Maturity and logical thinking	Demonstrate an outstanding understanding of the context of the discussion and offer excellent critical thinking with good analysis using current issues as examples.	Demonstrate an adequate understanding of the context of the discussion and sufficient critical thinking with adequate examples.	Demonstrate a sufficient understanding of the context of the discussion and offering minimal critical thinking with outdated /lack/ no examples.	Demonstrate a minimal understanding in the context of discussion and offer less than adequate critical thinking in the debate on the topic.	Not able to demonstrate understanding on the context of discussion and offer no critical thinking in discussing the topic.	
	Excellent (9-10)	**Good (7-8)**	**Average (5-6)**	**Need Improvement (3-4)**	**Poor (0-2)**	
Conclusion	The conclusion restates the research question or offers a comment or question on it. Effective and varied transitions link all ideas.	The conclusion restates the topic but not offer any comment or question on it.	The conclusion is written with good explanation of the contents but not sufficient as a whole.	The conclusion is too general, which is inadequate for the entire content.	No conclusion is provided for the entire contents / the conclusion is too little and not related to the topic discussed.	
	(5)	**(4)**	**(3)**	**(2)**	**(0-1)**	
References	Uses sources to support, extend, and inform, but not substitute the writer's development of the idea. Combines material from a variety of sources, including observation/ scientific testimony/ etc. Do not overuse data authoritative quotes. Quotations and works cited conform to APA style.	Uses sources to support, extend, and inform, but not substitute writer's own development of ideas. Do not overuse quotes, conform to the required style but maybe occasional error/ general. Quotations and works cited conform to APA style.	Uses relevant sources but lacks in variety of sources/ not be integrated well within the paper's argument. Quotations and paraphrases may be too long and/or inconsistently conform to APA style.	Neglects important sources. Overuse of quotations or paraphrases to substitute the writer's ideas. Possibly uses source material without or without adequate acknowledgment. No quotations, paraphrases/ Quotations, and works cited do not conform to APA style.	No reference and citation/ the references and citation are too much/ all the content of the discussion is just based on personal opinion without being supported by any or not genuine sources. There are no quotations, and the works cited do not conform to APA style.	
Format	Paperwork conforms to all requirements given for the paper writing format.	The paperwork almost fully complies with the writing format.	The paperwork does not fully comply with the writing format.	Paperwork does not comply with the paper writing format.	Paperwork does not comply with the paper writing format.	

Examiner 1 **Name:** **Signature:**	**Marks**	**Examiner 2** **Name:** **Signature:**	**Marks**	**Examiner 3** **Name:** **Signature:**	**Marks**	**Total**

Component Title	Part 2 (Creative Video Presentation) - 50 marks				Percentage (%)	20%
	(Group Marks- 30m)					
Criteria	Score and Descriptors					Marks
	Excellent (5)	Good (4)	Average (3)	Need Improvement (2)	Poor (1-0)	
Organization	The storyline is effectively expressed through video footage, sound, and special effects and is overall appealing. Scenes flow smoothly from one to the other without space. The main findings and their relevance are expressed well.	The storyline is expressedadequately through video footage, sound, and special effects and overalloffers some appeal. Most scenes flow smoothly from one to the other, andthere is little space. The majority of findings and their relevance are given.	The storyline lacks expression through some of the use of video footage, sound, and special effects and overall offers little appeal. Some scenes vaguely flow from one to the other, and there are many empty spaces and the audience needs to figure out the video's relevancy to understand the content discussed.	The storyline lacks expression through inadequate use of video footage, sound, and special effects and overall offers little appeal. Many scenes fail to flow smoothly from one to the other, and many empty spaces exist. Fewer findings and their relevance are given.	The storyline is hard to follow due to insufficient/ no use of video footage, sound, and special effects, and overall is confusing. There are many unnatural breaks between scenes and empty spaces. Findings and their relevance are not given.	
	(9-10)	(7-8)	(5-6)	(3-4)	(1-2)	
Content and Messages	The video offers a concise summary of the topic discussed and highlights the critical points of the study. It has exceptional and precise educational value and is comprehensive to the viewer (general audience.)	The video offers an adequate summary of the findings and some of the study's highlights. It offers adequate educational value to the presenter's peers and a wider audience.	The video provides the essential parts but does not adequately summarise the findings or highlights of the study. It offers general educational value to the presenter's peers and a wider audience.	The video fails to summarise the findings or highlights of the study adequately. The video offers moderate educational value to both the presenter's peers and a wider, general audience.	The video does not summarise the findings or highlights of the study. The video offers no educational value.	
	(5)	(4)	(3)	(2)	(0-1)	
Audio and Graphics	Graphics, animation and other visuals are effectively used to express the purpose and findings of the study	Most of the graphics, animation and other visuals are generally helpful for expressing the purpose and findings of the study	Only some of the graphics, animation and other visuals are generally helpful for expressing the purpose and findings of the study,	Graphics, animation and other visuals are generally unhelpful for expressing the purpose and findings of the study,	Graphics, animation and other visuals are ineffectively used to express the purpose and findings of the study, add confusion and are more distracting than helpful.	
Creativity	The visual and audio content of the video are creatively used to effectively express the purpose, findings and conclusions of the study.	For the most part, the visual and audio content of the video are creatively used to express the purpose, findings and conclusions of the study.	For the most part, the visual and audio content of the video are not creatively used, and just a basic presentation to convey the main messages of the study.	The visual and audio content of the video are not creatively used and fail to express the purpose, findings and conclusions of the study.	There is no creativity but mainly just a reading session based on the topic discussed to the topic discussed.	
Originality	The video genuinely gives original ideas. The ideas are brilliant, witty, and extraordinary.	The video shows a certain originality. It shows the use of new ideas and shrewdness.	The ideas in the video are not entirely original, but it is a combination of many different sources.	The content of the video comes from ideas from other people/sources with the acknowledgment, but there is little evidence of original ideas.	The ideas of the video come from other people/sources and have no acknowledgment, and it is not an original idea.	

	(Individual Marks- 20m)					
	Excellent (9-10)	**Good (7-8)**	**Average (5-6)**	**Need Improvement (3-4)**	**Poor (0-2)**	
Comprehension	Depth of content reflects knowledge and understanding of the topic. The main points are substantiated in a timely, relevant to the current issue, and sufficient support. All information presented in the video accurately and thoroughly explained the critical concept used in the presentation.	Adequate content reflects knowledge and understanding of the topic. The main points are substantiated with timely, relevant, and sufficient support. All information presented in the video accurately and thoroughly explained the concept used in the presentation.	Provides some support for main points, but needed to elaborate further with explanations and examples but not timely. Most information presented in the video was apparent in most parts of the presentation, accurate, and thorough.	Provides irrelevant or less supporting or elaboration for the points given. The explanations of concepts are inaccurate or incomplete. The audience had little knowledge of the presentation. Most of the information presented in the video is not usually accurate.	Provides irrelevant or no supporting or elaboration. The explanations for the point are given. The concepts given are inaccurate or incomplete. The audience had little knowledge of the presentation. Most of the information presented in the video is not usually accurate.	
	(5)	**(4)**	**(3)**	**(2)**	**(0-1)**	
Delivery and Narration	The presenter is exceptionally well prepared and delivers ideas in a clear and concise manner without depending on notes. The narration is clear, relaxed, and comprehensible, with a good pace and consistent style.	The presenter was well-prepared and delivered ideas with lots of eye contact. Narration is primarily clear, relaxed, and comprehensible, has a reasonable pace, and is primarily consistent in style throughout. A few times, the ideas were delivered with the aid of notes.	The presenter was somewhat prepared. Delivery of the presentation was made with the aid of notes. Some eye contact and good voice volume, tone, and pacing. Some appropriate gestures that supported the presentation.	The presenter was somewhat prepared. Delivery of the presentation was made but hugely dependent on notes and hesitation or memorization. There is minimal body language, the presentation is not very expressive, and there is no sign of the presentation's attitude.	The presenter was unprepared to present to the audience. Lack of eye contact, poor tone, and pacing. The narration is unclear and inconsistent style. The speech is not expressive. There is no intonation or body language, but the presenter only reads notes during the presentation.	
	(5)	**(4)**	**(3)**	**(2)**	**(0-1)**	
Engagement with the audience	Exceptional, effective use of attention-getting strategy(quote, statistic, question, story, etc.) to capture the listener's attention and introduce the topic. The presenter was able to sustain the audience's interest exceptionally and innovatively, as well as achieve the purpose of the presentation.	There is a use of an adequate attention-getting strategy, which seems to capture the audience's attention and/or lead to the desired outcome. The presenter kept the audience's attention the whole time, and the purpose of the presentation was achieved.	A relevant attention-getting strategy was used but did not capture the audience's attention adequately. The presenter was somewhat enthusiastic and kept the audience's attention for the most part. The purpose of the presentation was mainly achieved.	The use of an attention-getting strategy is not relevant. The presenter lacked enthusiasm; the audience's attention showed disinterest in some parts, and the purpose of the presentation was partially achieved.	No attention-getting strategy and no explicit or relevant connection to the topic were evident. The presenter was unenthusiastic; the audience's attention showed disinterest, and the presentation's purpose was not achieved.	
	You are required to write the presenters' names according to the video's sequence of presentations.					
No. Of sequence.	**Name**	**Student Id**		**Examiner 1**	**Examiner 2**	
1.	Ang Wei Ting	ADT2409053				
2.	Chen Chin Yu	ADT2409061				
3.	Ongarbay Ayazhan	ADT2409120				
4.	Chong Yu Qian	ADT2409068				
5.	Chen Yi Yen	ADT2409063				
6.	Ng Chin Mun	ADT2409095				
7.						

Examiner 1	Marks	Examiner 2	Marks	Examiner 3	Marks	Total
Name: Signature:		Name: Signature:		Name: Signature:		

Reminder to students:

You must attach this rubric with the coursework submission. Failure to follow any of the instructions and requirements will lead to a deduction of 10 marks. No excuse will be entertained.